

survive, and though their subjects' identities may have long faded away, their images remain, some elegant and refined, others tremulously hopeful, still others swaggering, brandishing swords or pistols—all insisting, in the words of one historian: “I was here. Remember me when I’m gone.”

As well as being the first conflict to have its participants thus immortalized, the Civil War was also the first to have its field operations documented. In 1861, Brady was determined to photograph every facet of the war, dispatching teams of photographers to cover as many armies as he could get permits for. Most of the leading cameramen of the day, including Gardner, Timothy O’Sullivan, George Barnard, and James Reekie, worked for Brady at one time or another. But every image produced by a photographer on his payroll was nevertheless credited “Photo by Brady,” perhaps because he bore the considerable expense of putting them in the field. Gardner eventually left to set up his own shop, enticing O’Sullivan and others to join him.

1,000,000 The estimated number of photographs made during the war, over 90 percent of which were portraits.



A photographic record

Published in 1866 and accompanied by explanatory text, the 100 mounted photographs in Alexander Gardner's *Photographic Sketchbook of the War* came to define how Americans envisioned the conflict.